

Building a Website Blocker Extension in Minutes



This tutorial explains how you can build a website blocker extension that will run on multiple browsers.

Web browsers have become integral to our lives, and are used on a wide range of devices, including desktops, laptops, tablets and smartphones. In 2019, an estimated 4.3 billion people used Web browsers. The most used browser today is Google Chrome, with a 64 per cent global market share across all devices, followed by Apple Safari with 17 per cent.

A few popular Web browsers

- **Google Chrome:** This popular cross-platform Web browser has been developed by Google. It was first released in 2008 for the Windows platform and was later ported to Linux, MacOS, iOS and Android. You can download Google Chrome from <https://www.google.com/chrome/>.
- **Opera:** This is a freeware browser for Windows, Android, iOS, MacOS and Linux, developed by Opera Software. It is a Chromium based browser using the Blink layout engine. What differentiates it from other browsers is a unique user interface, and a few other features. You can download Opera from <https://www.opera.com/hi/download>.
- **Brave:** This is a free and open source Web browser developed by Brave Software Inc., based on the Chromium framework. This browser has ad-blocking and website tracker-blocking features inbuilt. It also allows users to send cryptocurrency contributions in the form of Basic Attention

Tokens to websites and content creators. You can download Brave from <https://brave.com/download/>.

- **Microsoft Edge:** This is a Web browser developed by Microsoft. It was rebuilt as a Chromium based browser in 2019. It is also available for Windows, Android, iOS and MacOS. You can download Microsoft Edge from <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/edge>.

What is a browser extension?

A browser extension is a small software module that customises or adds extra functionality to the browser. This extension enhances or adds some extra features to the browser. The extensions are mostly written using Web technologies like HTML, JavaScript and CSS. They are hosted on vendor specific stores. For example, Chrome extensions are hosted on the Chrome Web Store, Mozilla Firefox hosts its extensions on its extension store, and so on. Users can go to the store of the browser they are using to download and install any of the wide variety of browser extensions available there.

Creating an extension

We are now going to build a website blocker extension, which will run on multiple Web browsers (Google Chrome, Opera, Brave and Microsoft Edge). This extension will allow users to block websites in a browser. Users can add